



WHEN I'M BETTER, WE'LL GO AND LOOK AT THE TRAINS AGAIN

PATHER PANCHALI / 1955

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Drama

DIRECTOR

Satyajit Ray

WRITERS

Satyajit Ray (screenplay);

Bibhutibhushan

Bandyopadhyay (novel)

STARS

Kanu Banerjee, Karuna Banerjee, Subir Banerjee, Chunibala Devi

BEFORE

1948 Vittorio De Sica's *The Bicycle Thief* inspires Ray to make the story of Apu.

AFTER

1956 Ray's follow-up to *Pather Panchali*, *Aparajito*, continues the story of Apu, who journeys to a new life in Calcutta.

1959 The final movie in the "Apu Trilogy," *Apur Sansar* follows the adult Apu on a trip to a provincial town that will change his life forever.

Pather Panchali tells the story of Apu (Subir Banerjee), a young boy learning about the world around him. He lives with his mother, father, sister, and aunt in an impoverished Bengali village in India. The family edges ever closer to financial ruin, but Apu's eyes are full of wonder. Although his life is blighted by despair, he doesn't yet know it, and director Satyajit Ray allows the audience to share in his protagonist's innocence.

Apu isn't the only one who is learning. Ray himself had never written or directed a movie before; his cast had never acted before, with the exception of Chunibala Devi; the photographer Subrata Mitra, whose cinematography captures the languid beauty of an Indian summer, had never worked with moving images; even Ravi Shankar, who provides the movie's shimmering sitar score, and who would later be world famous, was a novice.

The family cares for the elderly Indir Thakrun, played by Chunibala Devi, who died before the movie was released.

